

[ENTER COMPANY NAME]

QUALITY MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

Product Release to Market Authorization

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Review Cycle	Annual (Every 12 Months)
Applicable Regulatory Standards	ISO 13485:2016 Clauses 4.2.6, 7.5.1, & 8.2.6 FDA 21 CFR Part 820.80 & 820.160 EU MDR 2017/745 Article 15 (PRRC Mandate)

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1.0 Purpose

This Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) defines the mandatory requirements, record verification activities, and authorization steps necessary to formalize the transition of finished medical devices from a "Manufacturing/Quarantine" holding profile into "Active Commercial Inventory". The principal focus of this program is to guarantee that no product batch or lot is distributed into regional or global markets until a designated corporate Quality authority certifies absolute alignment with the Device Master Record (DMR) and prevailing regional regulatory certificates.

2.0 Scope

This procedure is universally applicable to all commercialized lots, finished diagnostic kits, sterile device batches, and electronic product updates prior to initial dispatch from shipping distribution docks. It governs the structural review of the complete Device History Record (DHR), raw laboratory data, inspection logs, and international regulatory clearance configurations.

3.0 Responsibility and Authority

3.1 Manufacturing / Operations Lead

Responsible for assembling all production lot paperwork, compiling line manufacturing reconciliation files, resolving raw material variances, and maintaining segregation within marked warehouse quarantine zones.

3.2 Quality Control (QC) Inspector / Laboratory Analyst

Responsible for performing final dimension checks, recording operational performance data, evaluating sterile barrier seal runs, and uploading certificate results to corporate data archives.

3.3 Qualified Release Authority / Person Responsible for Regulatory Compliance (PRRC)

Holds absolute organizational authority to execute the final release decision, sign off on the commercial distribution log, and transition the physical lot inventory state from "Quarantine" to "Released" inside the ERP platform.

4.0 Procedure

4.1 Comprehensive Device History Record (DHR) Review Protocol

Prior to formal market commercialization, a designated QA Specialist must execute a rigorous line-by-line audit of the manufacturing lot file. The check covers a complete data package to ensure structural compliance with the target Device Master Record (DMR):

DHR Audit Target Section	Critical Verification Requirements & Data Fields	Pass/Fail Verification Artifact
Material Reconciliation	Verify that all raw material part numbers, component lot numbers, and supplier tracking tags match current Bill of Materials (BOM) revisions.	Signed material routing cards and warehouse pick logs.
In-Process Control Logs	Verify that cleanroom torque values, adhesive curing times, heat seal pressure readings, and automated optical check numbers stayed within established specification limits.	Validated automated parameter charts and line data check sheets.
Sterilization Record Sets	Confirm that Ethylene Oxide parameters, gamma dosimeter mapping logs, or autoclave charts completely match validated process baselines.	Sterilization processing run certificates and biological indicator negative growth files.
Labeling & UDI Audit	Verify that printed serial/lot sequences match the physical boxes exactly. Confirm that Unique Device Identification (UDI) data matrix barcodes are crisp and fully scannable.	Retained sample physical labels affixed directly to the audit file.

4.2 Nonconformity and Deviation Verification Gateway

The release authority must verify that all in-process nonconformities, material escapes, component defects, or machine breakdowns logged during production have been formally resolved under established QMS procedures. If a manufacturing step required a process deviation, the QA Specialist must confirm that the deviation is approved, technically justified, and that its associated risk assessment shows no negative impact on product safety, effectiveness, or regulatory compliance.

CRITICAL SEGREGATION MANDATE: Under no circumstances shall any batch with an open, unresolved material nonconformity or active engineering deviation report clear the final release gateway. The product inventory must remain physically locked and systemically blocked within the ERP platform.

4.3 Step-by-Step Market Authorization Workflow

The final authorization sequence must progress through the following unyielding structural steps:

- Step 1: Document Package Submission**

The manufacturing department compiles the complete production batch file, attaches all QC data cards, and submits the physical or electronic folder to the QA Release unit.
- Step 2: Technical and Regulatory Verification Check**

The QA Release specialist verifies the document completeness, confirms that the target market has active

regulatory clearances (e.g., active FDA 510(k) or valid CE Certificate), and ensures the label matches specific national language requirements.

Step 3: Signature Execution and Inventory Migration

The PRRC or Head of Quality signs a formal Certificate of Compliance (CoC) and Product Release Authorization form. This signature allows the systemic release inside the company's ERP platform, moving the lot inventory status from "Quarantine" to "Available Stock".

4.4 Control of Post-Release Retain Samples

For each commercial release lot, an explicitly defined sample size of finished product must be pulled and archived in a dedicated, environment-controlled retain cage. Retain quantities are calculated to allow for complete duplicate technical evaluations if field performance complaints, legal litigation, or regulatory inspectorate challenges arise during the product's commercial lifecycle.

5.0 Records Lifecycle and Preservation

The closed DHR package, physical retain labels, engineering deviations, signed Release Authorizations, and regional Certificates of Compliance constitute primary quality assets. In strict compliance with FDA and EU MDR frameworks, these records must be archived in a secure repository for a minimum duration of the device lifecycle as defined in the technical documentation, but absolutely no less than ten (10) years from the date the specific unit cleared commercial release (or fifteen [15] years for active implantable device lines).

6.0 Associated Reference Materials

- **SOP-QA-001:** Document and Data Control System
- **SOP-QA-012:** Process and Equipment Validation Framework [cite: 21]
- **SOP-QA-015:** Material Nonconformity Management SOP
- **Form-QA-014A:** DHR Audit and Final Release Authorization Checklist

7.0 Revision History Log

Revision Level	Effective Date	Author / Originator	Detailed Description of Modifications
00	[Date]	[Name], Quality Assurance	Initial baseline release of formalized Product Release to Market Authorization Standard Operating Procedure.